

Find out more

IF YOU WOULD LIKE TO find out more about plants, you won't have to search far. Indeed, you only have to look around you. Go exploring in your own garden or start growing a window box. Armed with a plant identification handbook, take a walk in your local park or nature preserve, where you will find plenty of specimens to admire and study. For more exotic species and a wealth of information, visit a botanical garden, or to check out ancient plant fossils, take a trip to a natural history museum. Flower markets can also be an interesting and colorful experience.

GO WILD

To see plants in a completely natural setting, just head for your local nature preserve (bring an adult along). Spring is a good time to observe budding flowers and new shoots. Few sights compare to a meadow in midsummer bloom with wildflowers.

Wild flowers should not be plucked, since this disturbs the natural environment

This garden pansy will lose some of its color as it dries

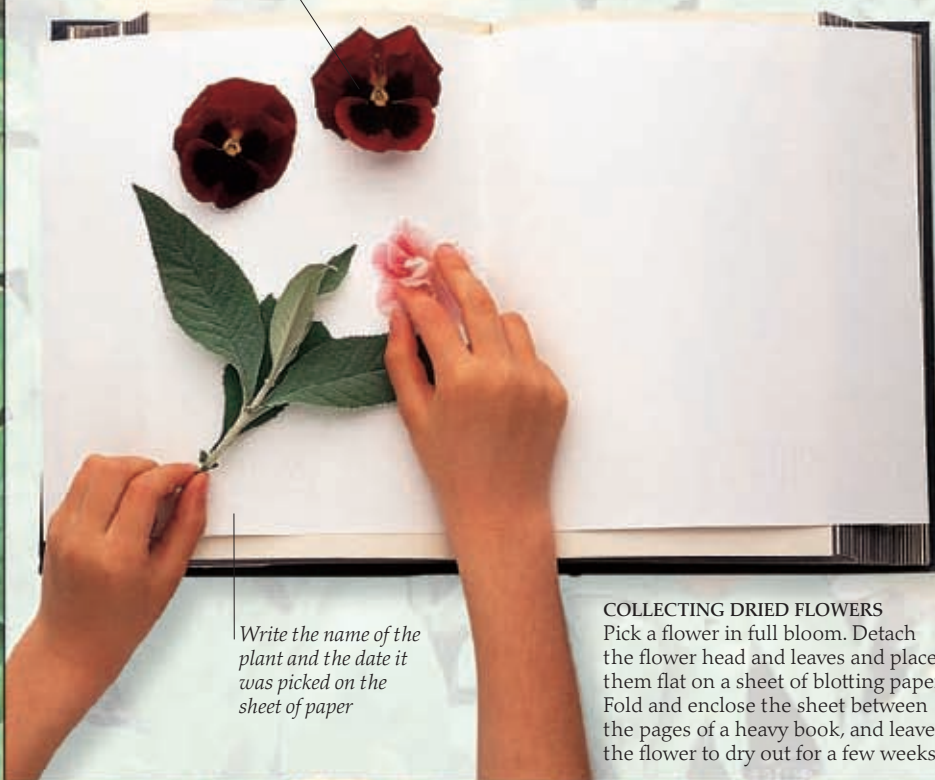


If an area of land is privately owned, always seek permission to visit from the owner



BOTANICAL GARDENS

A botanical garden is dedicated to plants from around the world. Rare and exotic species are cultivated, often in specially controlled environments, such as greenhouses. Desert plants, for example, must be kept in a hot, dry climate for survival.



Write the name of the plant and the date it was picked on the sheet of paper

COLLECTING DRIED FLOWERS

Pick a flower in full bloom. Detach the flower head and leaves and place them flat on a sheet of blotting paper. Fold and enclose the sheet between the pages of a heavy book, and leave the flower to dry out for a few weeks.